SOP – Azure VM Image Replication: Add Sweden Central (Latest Versions Only)

Version 1.0 · October 2026

Purpose

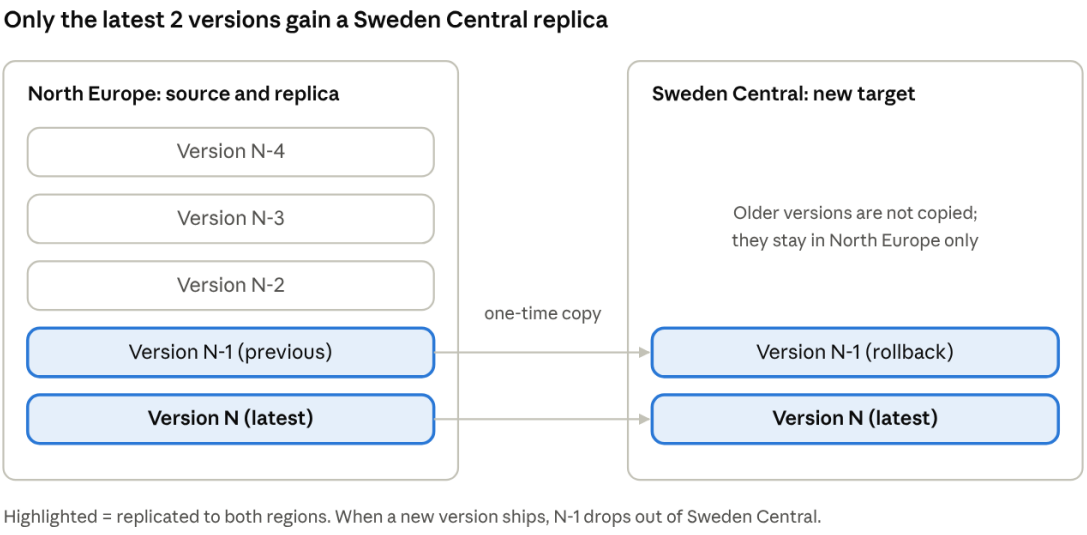
Our VM images sit in an Azure Compute Gallery in North Europe and are replicated to North Europe only. This SOP adds Sweden Central as a replication target for the **latest image versions only**, so we can deploy there without paying to copy the whole version history.

Why

- A VM can only be built from an image version that has a replica in that region.
- A second EU copy gives us a fallback if North Europe has problems.
- Every replica is billed as storage, per region. New builds always use the latest version, so copying old versions is wasted spend.
- Scope: **latest 2 versions** (current + previous for rollback). Everything older stays in North Europe.

Before you start

- Contributor access on the gallery's resource group
- Approved change ticket
- Latest 2 versions identified (Versions tab, sorted by Published date)
- Sweden Central allowed by Azure Policy on the subscription



replication scope · current vs target

Steps (Azure portal)

1. In the portal, search **Azure compute galleries** and open the gallery.
2. Open the image definition and go to **Versions**. Sort by Published date and note the latest two. Their replication should show North Europe only.
3. Open the latest version and select **Update replication** (under Settings).
4. Under Target regions, add **Sweden Central**:
    - Replica count: **1** (increase only for large parallel deployments, roughly 1 per 20 VMs)
    - Storage SKU: **Standard LRS** (Standard ZRS if we need zone resilience)
5. Leave the North Europe row exactly as it is. Removing it deletes that replica.
6. Click **Save**.
7. Repeat steps 3–6 for the previous version. Do not touch older versions.
8. On the version's **Overview**, check Replication status. Wait until Sweden Central shows **Completed**.

Validation

- Latest 2 versions list North Europe + Sweden Central; older versions list North Europe only.
- From the latest version, click **Create VM**, pick Sweden Central, confirm it deploys and boots, then delete the test VM.

Rollback

Open the version → **Update replication** → remove the Sweden Central row → **Save**. North Europe is not affected.

On every new release

- When creating the new version, add both North Europe and Sweden Central on the **Replication** tab.
- Remove Sweden Central from the version that is now third-latest (Update replication → remove row → Save). This keeps Sweden Central at exactly 2 versions.

Cost impact

Adding Sweden Central for the latest 2 versions costs about **$7.68/month (~$92/year) per image** for a 64 GB image. North Europe cost doesn't change; the gallery itself is free.

What we pay for

- Replica storage in Sweden Central: ~$0.05 per GB per month (Standard LRS snapshot rate), per version, per replica
- Copy from North Europe to Sweden Central: $0.02 per GB, once per version
- Extra replicas inside Sweden Central: no transfer charge, storage only

Formula

Monthly increase = (versions kept × replicas × image size GB × $0.05) + (new versions per month × image size GB × $0.02)

Example – 64 GB image, latest 2 versions, 1 replica, 1 release per month

Item	Calculation	Cost
Storage	2 × 1 × 64 GB × $0.05	$6.40 / month
Copy of new release	64 GB × $0.02	$1.28 / month
Monthly increase	$6.40 + $1.28	**$7.68**
Yearly increase	$7.68 × 12	**$92.16**
One-time initial copy	2 × 64 GB × $0.02	$2.56

Options compared (64 GB image)

Option	Monthly	Yearly
Latest 1 version	$4.48	$53.76
Latest 2 versions (chosen)	**$7.68**	**$92.16**
All versions (e.g. 12)	$39.68	$476.16

Limiting it to the latest 2 saves ~$32/month per image versus replicating everything. Figures are pay-as-you-go list prices in USD; check the Azure Pricing Calculator for our actual rates and multiply by the number of image definitions in scope. VM costs in Sweden Central are not included.